Equitas Small Finance Bank announces Balaji Nuthalapadi as interim CEO

SHINE JACOB
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Equitas Small Finance Bank Ltd announced on Wednesday that its board of directors, based on the recommendation of the Nomination and Remuneration Committee, has approved the appointment of Balaji Nuthalapadi, currently serving as a whole-time director (executive director) of the Bank, as its interim chief executive officer (CEO), subject to the approval of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI).

The appointment follows the resignation of P N Vasudevan as managing director and chief executive officer of the bank, citing investor concerns over a perceived conflict of interest arising from his daughter's association with a non-banking financial company.

As the executive director, Nuthalapadi has played a pivotal role in enhancing digital capabilities, upgrading technology and improving operational efficiency. Prior to joining Equitas Small Finance Bank Limited, Nuthalapadi was with Citi for 28 years and served as managing director and head of India citi solutions centers and head of India operations and technology.

BALAJI NUTHALAPADI'S APPOINTMENT WILL LIKELY TAKE EFFECT FROM THE DATE OF RBI APPROVAL OR SUCH OTHER DATE AS MAY BE STIPULATED BY RBI

He worked in multiple geographies across Asia and EMEA in roles spanning asset sales, wealth management, re-engineering, consumer operations and technology and Global Capability Center leadership where he led the scale-up of Citi's global hubs in India.

Nuthalapadi's appointment will take effect from the date of RBI approval or such other date as may be stipulated by the RBI. Equitas shall ensure to its stakeholders and investors that smooth and seamless transition which connote stability, said a statement.

The Board has placed on record its deep appreciation and sincere gratitude to Vasudevan for his invaluable contributions, exemplary leadership and dedicated service to the Bank during his tenure. The Bank will determine his relieving date following the receipt of RBI approval for the interim CEO appointment and in consultation with Vasudevan.